TOUCH ENGLISH™
SPEAK WITH CONFIDENCE

STUDENT WORKBOOK · LEVEL 2

Explain Why You Made a Decision

Explain | OREO | Decision Interview

Name: _____ Date: _____

SLIDE 02 Today's goal

By the end of this lesson, I can:

Explain a decision you made: what you chose and what you did not, the main reason with one example, the result now, and answer a why question.

WHO You look after the office equipment in a small company in Johor Bahru. Twelve people share one printer and print about 2,000 pages a month.

SITUATION In August the old laser printer broke; in July its toner cost RM200. You had two quotes, and on 2 September you bought the ink-tank printer (RM1,100), not the laser printer (RM700).

NEED It is early October. Mei Ling in accounts is checking September's bills. She sees both quotes and asks why you paid RM400 more. She must write one line for Mr. Tan.

GOAL Explain what you chose and what you did not choose, the main reason, one example and the result now. Then answer her questions.

Ink-tank printer (chosen)
- RM1,100
- Ink: about RM40 a month
- Two-year warranty

Laser printer (not chosen)
- RM700
- Toner: about RM200 a month
- One-year warranty

SLIDE 03 Try it first

Mei Ling asks: "I'm checking September's bills. Why did you buy the RM1,100 printer? The other one was RM700." Say something for 30 seconds. Then note what you said.

SLIDE 04 A good message

Ali's answer. Mark where each part starts.

I know it was RM400 more, but I chose the ink-tank printer for RM1,100, not the laser printer for RM700. I chose it because the ink is much cheaper. Ink for this printer costs about RM40 a month, but toner for a laser printer is about RM200. For example, in July we paid RM200 for toner for the old printer. In September we printed the same 2,000 pages, and the ink cost only RM40. So now we save about RM160 a month. Three months of that is more than the extra RM400. That's why I chose it.

O DECISION

_____

R REASON

_____

E EXAMPLE

_____

O RESULT NOW

_____

SLIDE 05 Organise it

Siti explains a training day she arranged. Put her sentences in order: Decision → Reason → Example → Result now.

- ☐ So now 18 people can come, not 9. That's why I chose Saturday.
- ☐ I chose Saturday morning for the first-aid course, not Friday.
- ☐ For example, last Friday only 9 of our 20 staff were in the office.
- ☐ I chose Saturday because more than half of our staff visit customers on Fridays.

Write the letter: **O** = Decision · **R** = Reason · **E** = Example · **O** = Result now

SLIDE 06 Useful language

Tick the expressions you used today.

SAY WHAT YOU CHOSE

- [ ] I chose …, not …
- [ ] I chose … instead of …
- [ ] In the end, I went for …

GIVE THE REASON

- [ ] I chose it because …
- [ ] The main reason is that …
- [ ] The other one was …, but …

GIVE AN EXAMPLE

- [ ] For example, …
- [ ] Last month, …
- [ ] Before, we … Now we …

SAY THE RESULT NOW

- [ ] So now …
- [ ] That's why I chose …
- [ ] It works well now, because …

CHECK UNDERSTANDING

- [ ] Is that clear?
- [ ] Does that make sense?
- [ ] Shall I say that again?
- [ ] Any other questions?

SLIDE 07 Connect the ideas

Choose the connector and write the new sentence.

1. I chose the ink-tank printer. [because / for example, / so] The ink is much cheaper.

_____

2. The ink costs RM40 a month, not RM200. [but / because / so] We save about RM160 a month.

_____

3. The laser printer was RM400 cheaper. [so / but / if] Its toner costs about RM200 a month.

_____

4. The ink is much cheaper. [If / But / For example,] In September it cost only RM40.

_____

SLIDE 08 Time control

Circle the right form. Why?

1. Last month I _____ the ink-tank printer. (The decision (finished))
   - ○ choosing
   - ○ choosed
   - ○ chose
2. I _____ the laser printer. (The option you did not take)
   - ○ didn't chose
   - ○ didn't choose
   - ○ not chose
3. The ink _____ about RM40 a month. (A fact about now)
   - ○ is cost
   - ○ costing
   - ○ costs
4. So now we _____ about RM160 a month. (The result now)
   - ○ saves
   - ○ save
   - ○ saving

SLIDE 09 Past for the decision · Present for now

The decision is finished, so it is Past. The facts and the result are true now, so they are Present.

On 2 September I **bought** the ink-tank printer.

We **didn't take** the cheaper one.

Toner for a laser printer **costs** about RM200 a month.

So now the printer **works** well and we **spend** less on ink.

SLIDE 10

Build your message

Fill each part with your own idea. You will use the same parts in the task.

O DECISION

I chose …, not …

R REASON

I chose it because …

E EXAMPLE

For example, …

O RESULT NOW

So now … That's why I chose … Does that make sense?

SLIDE 11

Decision Interview

The speaker explains a decision from a card: what they chose, instead of what, the main reason, one example and the result now. The interviewer cannot see the card, fills the Decision note, reads it back and asks one 'why' question and how it is now.

1. Speakers: one quiet minute with your card. Find the choice and the other option. Circle ONE reason and ONE example.
2. Round 1 (3:00): explain. The interviewer fills the note, reads it back, then asks 'Why not …?' and 'How is it now?'
3. Round 2 (2:00): interviewers move one seat. Same card, new interviewer, shorter: one reason, one example.
4. Round 3 (1:00): new interviewer. Speakers: card face down, workbook closed. Interviewers still write. Then swap roles.

Card 1 · The company van

Card 2 · The team lunch

Card 3 · The customer in Melaka

Card 4 · The showroom's day off

Decision note

	ROUND 1	ROUND 2	ROUND 3
Chose			
Instead of			
Reason + example			
Result now			

My partner's question or concern, and what I answered:

SLIDE 12 Respond

Mei Ling asks. Write a short answer to one of these.

1. When did you buy it?
2. Why didn't you choose the laser printer?
3. What happens if it breaks?

Start with: **I bought it on … · Because the toner … · It has a …**

SLIDE 13 Transfer

At a family dinner, a relative asks about a real choice you made at home: a phone, a car, a condo, a school. "Why that one, not the other one?" Explain. No real choice? You rented a condo in Tebrau (RM1,300, 10 minutes from work), not one in town (RM1,800, 35 minutes).

I chose …, not … · The main reason is that … · For example, … · So now … That's why …

SLIDE 14 Did I do it?

Be honest. Tick what you did in the task.

- [ ] Says what they chose and what they did not choose.
- [ ] Gives one main reason, with one example (a number, a day or a person).
- [ ] Says what the decision means now, and ends with the decision again.

SLIDE 15

Feedback: how can I improve?

Circle one number for each area. 1 = I need help · 2 = OK · 3 = Good

Choice and the other option	○ 1	○ 2	○ 3
Reason and example	○ 1	○ 2	○ 3
Result now	○ 1	○ 2	○ 3
Useful expressions	○ 1	○ 2	○ 3
Confidence	○ 1	○ 2	○ 3

My improvement action: Next time, I will _____.

WE BELIEVE IN THE POWER OF PRACTICAL SPEAKING TO INSPIRE CONFIDENCE

After class: open the After class review

SLIDE 11

Listener cards: fold or cut

Only the listener looks at a card. It says what to find out and write in the note.

Card 1 · The company van

You are Kumar. You were on leave for two months, and the company has a different van now. Write the Decision note. Then ask one 'why' question, for example: "Why not …?"

Card 2 · The team lunch

You are Siti. You will organise the next team lunch and want to learn from this one. Write the Decision note. Then ask one 'why' question.

Card 3 · The customer in Melaka

You are Mr. Tan. You did not join the meeting with the Melaka customer, and you want to know what the sales team decided. Write the Decision note. Then ask one 'why' question.

Card 4 · The showroom's day off

You are Ali. You look after the showroom's computers, and you heard that the opening days have changed. Write the Decision note. Then ask one 'why' question.

SLIDE 11

Speaker cards: fold or cut

Only the speaker looks at a card. The listener keeps this page folded.

Card 1 · The company van

Now: all deliveries on time again since April · A new van: a 4-month wait · Not: a new van, RM95,000 · In March: the old van broke down, 9 late deliveries · Chose: a second-hand van, RM38,000 · Ready in 1 week · Only 40,000 km

Card 2 · The team lunch

16 staff, one-hour lunch · Now: Mr. Tan wants the same place in December · Not: hotel buffet, RM45 a head, 25 minutes by car · Last year, half the team came back 40 minutes late · Chose: a mamak, 5 minutes' walk, RM15 a head

Card 3 · The customer in Melaka

The customer only needed to see 2 samples · Chose: a video call · Melaka: 3 hours each way · Now: they order 500 pieces a month · Samples sent by courier the day before (RM25) · Not: driving to Melaka · The call took 40 minutes

Card 4 · The showroom's day off

Staff now rest on Mondays · Chose: open on Sundays, close on Mondays · Sundays: about 60 customers a day · Not: close on Sundays · Mondays: about 10 customers · First open Sunday: 4 sofas sold · Now: sales up RM20,000 a month